

Northwind Apparel - Order Calendar and Programme Notes

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Account overview

Northwind Apparel is the largest account for basic knits and takes the majority of GAR-001 Classic Black Polo and GAR-002 White Cotton T-Shirt volume. The account works on a replenishment model rather than seasonal drops, so demand is steadier than the fashion accounts but responds sharply to their promotions.

Order windows

Northwind places four indicative buys a year and confirms quantities six weeks before each ship window.

Window	Placed	Ships	Typical volume
Spring replenishment	January	March	8,000 to 10,000 units
Mid-year promotion	April	June	12,000 to 15,000 units
Autumn replenishment	July	September	9,000 to 11,000 units
Holiday programme	September	November	14,000 to 18,000 units

The mid-year and holiday windows are consistently the two largest. A forecast that projects a flat line through June or November is understating demand, because those uplifts are programme-driven rather than random variation.

Promotion behaviour

Northwind runs a two-for-one polo promotion in their June and November campaigns. Historically this lifts GAR-001 by 25 to 35 percent above the preceding quarter's monthly average, and lifts GAR-002 by roughly 15 percent as an attachment purchase.

The promotion is confirmed to us about eight weeks ahead. Where a forecast increase coincides with a known promotion window, the increase should be treated as expected rather than as a new trend, because volume returns to the baseline in the following month.

Service expectations

Northwind allows a three day delivery window either side of the confirmed date and applies a 2 percent invoice deduction beyond that. They do not accept partial shipments on replenishment orders.